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Sir Anthony Atkinson Chair in Economics, London School of Economics

publications

+ “Poverty Traps” with R. Burgess, A.Heil, M. Sulaiman forthcoming in the Handbook of Development Economics
+ “Safe Spaces for Teenage Girls in a Time of Crisis”, with Niklas Buehren, Markus Goldstein and Andrea Smurra, Journal of the European Economic Association
+ The Search for Good Jobs: Evidence from a Six-Year Experiment in Uganda” with V. Bassi, Robin Burgess, Imran Rasul, Munshi Sulaiman and Anna Vitali, Journal of Labor Economics
+ "Graduation" with R. Burgess, A.Heil, M. Sulaiman forthcoming in the “Handbook of Social Protection”
+ “Social incentives, delivery agents, and the effectiveness of development interventions” with R Burgess, E Deserranno, R Morel, M Sulaiman, I Rasul, Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics 1 (1), 2023
+ “Economic Development and the Organisation of Labour: Evidence from the Jobs of the World Project”, with A Elsayed, A Heil, A Smurra, Presidential address, Journal of the European Economic Association 20 (6), 2226-2270 2022
+ “Microfinance and Diversification” with R Burgess, E Deserranno, R Morel, I Rasul, M Sulaiman, Economica 89, S239-S275, Centenary Issue 2022
+ “Men are from Mars, and Women Too: A Bayesian Meta-analysis of Overconfidence Experiments”, with N Parekh, B Petrongolo, M Rao, Economica 89, S38-S70, Centenary Issue, 2022
+ “Young adults and labor markets in Africa” with A Elsayed, A Smurra, C Zipfel Journal of Economic Perspectives 36 (1), 81-100
+ “Why do people stay poor?” with Clare Balboni, Robin Burgess, Anton Heil and Maitreesh Ghatak, Quarterly Journal of Economics 2021
+ The Allocation of Authority in Organizations:A Field Experiment with Bureaucrats" with Michael Best, Adnan Khan and Andrea Prat, Quarterly Journal of Economics 2021
+ "Do women respond less to performance pay? Building evidence from multiple experiments“ with Greg Fischer Andrea Prat and Erina Ytsma AER: Insights 2021
+ Tackling Youth Unemployment: Evidence from a Labour Market Experiment in Uganda" with Livia Alfonsi, Vittorio Bassi, Robin Burgess, Imran Rasul, Munshi Sulaiman and Anna Vitali 2020, Econometrica

+ “The Distinctive Values of Bankers” with Nava Ashraf and Alexia Delfino, 2020 American Economic Review P&P
+ "Losing Prosociality in the Quest for Talent?" with Nava Ashraf, Ed Davenport and Scott Lee, 2020, American Economic Review *Arrow Award
+ "CEO Behavior and Firm Performance" with Stephen Hansen, Andrea Prat and Raffaella Sadun, 2019 Journal of Political Economy
+ “Women's Empowerment in Action: Evidence from a Randomized Control Trial in Africa”, with Niklas Buehren, Robin Burgess, Markus Goldstein, Selim Gulesci, Imran Rasul and Munshi Sulaiman, 2019 AEJ:Applied
+ "Social Incentives" with Nava Ashraf 2018 Annual Reviews of Economics
+ “Nation-Building Through Compulsory Schooling During the Age of Mass Migration” with Imran Rasul, Myra Mohnen and Martina Viarengo 2018 Economic Journal
+ “Managing the Family Firm: Evidence from CEOs at Work”, with Renata Lemos, Andrea Prat & Raffaella Sadun. Review of Financial Studies 2018 EDITOR'S CHOICE
+ “Altruistic Capital" with Nava Ashraf American Economic Review P&P 2017
+ “Labor Markets and Poverty in Village Economies” with Robin Burgess, Narayan Das, Selim Gulesci, Imran Rasul and Munshi Sulaiman. Quarterly Journal of Economics 2017
+ “No margin, no mission? a field experiment on incentives for public service delivery.” with Nava Ashraf and Kelsey Jack, Journal of Public Economics 2014
+ “Matching Firms, Managers and Incentives” with Lugi Guiso, Andrea Prat and Raffaella Sadun Journal of Labor Economics 2015
+ “Active and Passive Waste in Government Spending: Evidence from a Policy Experiment.” with Andrea Prat and Tommaso Valletti American Economic Review, September 2009, 99: 1278-1308
+ “Social Connections and Incentives in the Workplace: Evidence from Personnel Data” with
+ wan Barankay and Imran Rasul Econometrica, July 2009, 77: 1047-94.
+ “Social capital in the workplace: Evidence on its formation and consequences” with Imran Rasul and Iwan Barankay, invited submission Labour Economics, August 2008, vol. 15(4), pages 724-748
+ “Contract Duration and Investment Incentives: Evidence from Land Tenancy Agreements in 19th century Italy.” Journal of the European Economic Association, September 2007: vol. 5(5), pages 953-986.
- “Incentives for Managers and Inequality Among Workers: Evidence from a Firm Level Experiment” with Imran Rasul and Iwan Barankay. Quarterly Journal of Economics May 2007 122: 729-75.
- “Land Distribution, Incentives and the Choice of Production Techniques: Theory and Evidence from Rural Nicaragua.” World Bank Economic Review, May 2007: 21(3):487-508

- "Social Networks and the Adoption of New Technology in Northern Mozambique" with Imran Rasul. Lead article Economic Journal October 2006: 116: 862-902.
- "Traders, Cops and Robbers" with James Anderson. Journal of International Economics, September 2006 vol. 70(1), pages 197-215
- "The Evolution of Cooperative Norms: Evidence from a Field Experiment" with Iwan Barankay and Imran Rasul. Lead article, Invited Submission, Advances to Economic Analysis & Policy, special issue on Field Experiments John A. List (ed), April 2006, vol. 6(2).
- "Social Preferences and the Response to Incentives: Evidence from Personnel Data" with Imran Rasul and Iwan Barankay. Quarterly Journal of Economics August 2005 vol. 120(3), pages 917-962
- "Cooperation in Collective Action" with Imran Rasul and Iwan Barankay. Invited Submission Economics of Transition Special Issue: Symposium on Institutions and economic performance, Banerjee,A. and Ghatak, M. (eds) July 2005, vol. 13(3), pages 473-498
- "Private Enforcement and Social Efficiency" with James Anderson. Journal of Development Economics, 2005 vol. 77(2), pages 341-366
- "Robin Hood's Compromise: the Economics of Moderate Land Reforms" with Gilat Levy. Contributions to Economic Analysis & Policy: Vol. 3: No. 1, Article 19. 2004
- "Private States and the Enforcement of Property Rights: Theory and evidence on the origins of the Sicilian mafia"- Journal of Law, Economics and Organization, Spring 2003: vol. 19(1), pages 218-244
- "Does Financial Liberalisation Raise or Reduce Savings?" with G.Caprio, P.Honohan, F.Schiantarelli, Review of Economics and Statistics, May 2000: vol. 82(2), pages 239-263

Awards

Birgit Grodal Award, European Economic Association 2026

Premio De Sanctis for Economics, Fondazione De Sanctis 2025

Honorary foreign member, American Economic Association 2022

Honorary Doctorate, University of Munich 2021

IHEA Arrow award, best paper in health 2021

LSE SU Teaching Award, for innovative teaching 2020

Yrjö Jahnsson Award, joint with Imran Rasul for outstanding contribution to economics in Europe 2019

Ester Boserup Prize for Research on Development: for outstanding social science research on development and economic history 2018

Carlo Alberto Medal: Awarded biennially to an outstanding Italian economist under the age of 40; 2011

IZA Young Labor Economist Award for "Social Preferences and the Response to Incentives: Evidence from Personnel Data" with Imran Rasul and Iwan Barankay. Quarterly Journal of Economics; 2007

American Economic Review "Excellence in Refereering" 2009, 2011, 2012, 2014

other positions

Econometrica: co-Editor

European Economic Association: past president

Collegio Carlo Alberto: vice-president

International Growth Centre: Co-Director, State Capabilities Programme and Member of the Board.

Fellow: British Academy; Econometric Society; Centre for Economic Policy Research (CEPR); Bureau for the Analysis of Economic Development (BREAD); IZA; CESIfo; Innovation for poverty action (IPA); JPAL Europe; European Development Research Network (EUDN).

previous academic appointments

LSE Department of Economics. August 2007-July 2010: Reader in Economics

LSE Department of Economics. September 1999-July 2007: Lecturer in Economics

Northwestern University, Department of Economics and CSIO. March-May 2007: Visiting Assistant Professor.

IIES, Stockholm. March 2006: Visiting Assistant Professor

graduate students first placement

1. Ignacio Banares Sanchez, AP, Berkeley ARE
2. Amen Jalal, PostDoc Harvard Academy, AP Harvard Kennedy School
3. Anton Heil, PostDoc Nuffield College, Oxford
4. Nilmini Herath, AP, Trinity College, Dublin
5. Ananya Kotia, PostDoc SIEPR, AP, Stanford GSB
6. Andrea Smurra, AP, City St George's, University of London
7. Caterina Soto Veira, AP IIES Stockholm
8. Sarah Winton, AP, University of Stockholm
9. Gabriela Deschamp, PostDoc UCL; AP Gothenburg
10. Gabriel Leite-Mariante, AP CUNEF Madrid
11. Michelle Rao, Research Fellow, CGD
12. Philipp Barteska, PostDoc HKS, AP HKU
13. Gaia Dossi, PostDoc UCL, AP Centro Einaudi

14. Veronica Salazar- Restrepo, AP IIES Stockholm
15. Maria Ventura, AP, Department of Economics, University of Edinburgh
16. Takafumi Kawakubo, Assistant Professor, Osaka University
17. Virginia Minni, Assistant Professor, Booth GSB, University of Chicago
18. Anna Vitali, Assistant Professor, Department of Economics NYU
19. Amanda Dahlstrand, Assistant Professor, University of Zurich
20. Martina Zanella, Assistant Professor, Trinity College Dublin
21. Yusuke Kuroishi, Hitoshubashi University
22. Celine Zipfel, Assistant Professor, Stockholm School of Economics
23. Antonella Bancalari, Assistant Professor, Univeristy of St. Andrews
24. Alexia Delfino, Assistant Professor, Universita' Bocconi
25. Jay Lee, Assistant Professor, Stockholm University
26. Niclas Moneke, Assistant Professor, University of Oxford
27. Shan Aman Rana, Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, UVA
28. Clare Balboni, 3M Assistant Professor, Department of Economics MIT
29. Roberto Sormani, Young Professional Program, World Bank
30. Torsten Walter, Assistant Professor, NYU Abu Dhabi
31. Florian Blum, Young Professional Program, World Bank
32. Nicola Limodio, Assistant Professor, Universita' Bocconi
33. Guo Xu, Assistant Professor, Haas, UC Berkeley
34. Anders Jensen, Assistant Professor, Kennedy School of Government, Harvard University
35. Giulia Zane, Post Doctoral Fellow, Department of Economics, Harvard University
36. Erika Deserranno, Assistant Professor, Kellog MEDS, Northwestern University
37. Laura Derksen, Assistant Professor, Rotman School of Management, University of Toronto
38. Erina Ytsma, Post Doctoral Fellow, Sloan School of Management, MIT
39. Michael Best, Post Doctoral Fellow, Stanford SIEPR
40. Anett Hoffman, Assistant Professor, CREST, Paris
41. Daniel Metzger, Assistant Professor, Stockholm School of Economics
42. Yanhui Wu, Assistant Professor, USC
43. Selim Gulesci, Assistant Professor, Universita' Bocconi
44. Prakarsh Singh, Assistant Professor, Umass Amherst
45. Sanchari Roy, Post Doctoral Fellow, University of Warwick.
46. Stefanie Sieber, Young Professional Program, World Bank
47. Sonia Goncalves, King's College
48. Jin Wang, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology, Hong Kong
49. Ameet Morjaria, Post Doctoral Fellow, Kennedy School of Government and Harvard Academy Junior Scholar, Weatherhead Centre for International Affairs, Harvard University
50. Kumar Aniket, New Hall & Trinity College, University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK
51. Irma Clots-Figueras, Universidad Carlos III, Madrid, Spain